

Brainstorming – Idea Generation & Prioritization

Project: Automated Network Request Management (ServiceNow)

1. Background

Employees and teams across the organization frequently need network changes or access — VPN access, firewall rule updates, new port openings, site-to-site connectivity, or guest network access — on their work devices or systems. Today this is typically requested informally via email or verbal request to IT/Network, resulting in delays, lost requests, no visibility into capacity or security review status, and inconsistent approval oversight from managers.

2. Brainstorming Session Goal

Generate and evaluate potential approaches to digitize and automate the network request lifecycle — from request submission through manager approval to IT/Network fulfillment — using the ServiceNow platform.

3. Ideas Generated

Idea	Description
Email-based request tracking	Continue using email but add a shared tracker (Excel/SharePoint) for visibility.
Standalone helpdesk ticket	Log every request as a generic IT ticket/incident with no structured approval flow.
ServiceNow Service Catalog item	Build a dedicated catalog item capturing request type (VPN access, firewall rule, new connectivity, guest access), justification, device/system, and required-by date; route through manager approval automatically.
Chatbot-driven request	Let employees request network access/changes via a chat interface that files the request behind the scenes.
Self-service network portal with capacity/security tracking	Full catalog item + automated approval + capacity/security policy check + auto-generated incident if the request cannot be fulfilled.

4. Prioritization (Impact vs. Effort)

Idea	Impact	Effort	Priority
Email + shared tracker	Low	Low	Not selected
Generic IT ticket	Medium	Low	Not selected
ServiceNow Catalog Item + Approval Flow	High	Medium	Selected ✓
Chatbot-driven request	Medium	High	Future enhancement
Full portal + capacity/security tracking	High	High	Phase 2 goal

5. Selected Approach

Build a ServiceNow Service Catalog item for network access/change requests, backed by a data-driven workflow: Catalog Item → Requested Item → Manager Approval → Fulfillment Task, with an automated Incident raised if a request cannot be fulfilled due to capacity or security policy constraints.

6. Why This Approach Was Prioritized

- Uses ServiceNow's native Service Catalog and Approval engine — no external tools needed.
- Gives employees a simple, guided form instead of ad-hoc emails.

- Gives managers a single, familiar place (My Approvals) to review and decide.
- Gives IT/Network teams a trackable fulfillment task instead of a buried email.
- Effort is moderate and achievable within the project timeline, while still demonstrating a complete real-world workflow.